Speak. Connect. Get Placed.

Basics of Communication & Soft Skills for Placement Success

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What We'll Cover Today

1	Welcome & Warm-Up	10 min
2	Foundations of Communication	20 min
3	Activity: Silent Story Challenge	10 min
4	Written Communication	5 min
5	Barriers to Communication	10 min
6	Languages of the World & English	10 min
7	7 Cs of Effective Communication	18 min
8	Recap + Open Floor (Q&A)	30 min

LET'S WARM UP OUR ENGLISH

60-Second Icebreaker

1. Turn to the person sitting next to you.
2. In English, tell them: your name, your branch, and one thing you're good at.
3. You each get 60 seconds. Ready? Go!

Don't worry about perfect grammar — just speak. This is a practice zone, not an exam.

WHY THIS SESSION MATTERS

The Real Placement Gap

70.15%

of engineering graduates are rated employable overall

Source: India Skills Report 2026 (Wheebox–CII–AICTE–AIU)

55.1%

are employable specifically in communication skills

Source: Mercer India Graduate Skill Index 2025

Technical skill gets you shortlisted. Communication gets you selected.

FOUNDATIONS

What Is Communication?

Communication is the process of sharing information, ideas, or feelings — and making sure the other person understands it the way you meant.

Talking is not the same as communicating.

Communication only succeeds when the message is understood — not just spoken. You can say every technical term correctly and still fail to communicate.



Share



Understand

Respond

The SMCR Model of Communication



Canteen analogy: You (Sender) tell the counter staff (Receiver) your order (Message) by speaking (Channel). Loud noise or unclear words can distort it — that's Noise. The staff repeating your order back is Feedback.

FOUNDATIONS

SMCR in a Placement Interview

SENDER	You, the candidate
MESSAGE	Your answer to "Tell me about yourself"
CHANNEL	Your voice, tone, and body language
RECEIVER	The interviewer
FEEDBACK	Their follow-up questions, nodding, or silence
NOISE	Nervousness, mumbling, jargon, poor eye contact

Three Ways We Communicate



Verbal

Spoken words — interviews, GDs, presentations



Non-Verbal

Body, face, tone — the unspoken message



Written

Text — resume, email, reports, LinkedIn

Verbal Communication

Communication through spoken words — tested in Group Discussions, Interviews, and Presentations.

- Speak at a steady pace — not too fast, not too slow
- Pronounce words clearly instead of mumbling
- Use simple, correct words rather than big or wrong ones
- Pause instead of filling gaps with "umm," "actually," "like"

Try this live: ask one student to answer "Why do you want this job?" rushed and mumbling, then slow and clear. Let the class notice the difference themselves.

TYPES OF COMMUNICATION

Non-Verbal Communication

What you communicate without saying a word.



Eye Contact



Facial Expression



Posture



Gestures



Handshake



Tone of Voice

An interviewer starts forming an impression before you say a word — through how you walk in, sit, and greet them.

NON-VERBAL COMMUNICATION, LIVE

Activity: The Silent Story Challenge

1. Two volunteers come to the front.
2. They act out a well-known short story — using ONLY gestures, facial expressions, and body movement. No words. No sounds.
3. The class watches carefully and calls out guesses.
4. Time limit: 3 minutes per team.

ACTIVITY

Pick Your Story

1

The Thirsty Crow

2

The Hare & The Tortoise

3

The Lion & The Mouse

4

The Monkey & The Crocodile

Presenter assigns 1 story per team (a chit system works well) — the rest of the class raises hands to guess.

After each round, ask the class: "What clues told you the story, even without words?" — connect answers back to eye contact, gesture, and expression.

TYPES OF COMMUNICATION

Written Communication

Communication through text — tested in resumes, cover letters, emails, LinkedIn profiles, and reports.

Recruiters often read your writing before they ever meet you.

Your resume and your first email are your first impression — and unlike speech, they stay on record and can be re-read, so mistakes are more visible, not less.

Writing a Professional Email

- ✓ Clear subject line — never leave it blank or write just "Hi"
- ✓ Formal greeting — "Dear Mr./Ms. ___" or "Dear Sir/Madam"
- ✓ Short, direct paragraphs — one idea per paragraph
- ✓ Polite closing — "Regards," or "Thank you," with your full name
- ✓ Proofread before sending — check spelling and the recipient's name

SECTION 2

Barriers to Communication

What gets in the way — and how to break through it

BARRIERS

5 Common Barriers



Language

Different words, meanings, accents



Psychological

Fear, shyness, low confidence



Physical

Noise, distance, poor connectivity



Cultural

Different norms & assumptions



Technological

Bad network, dropped calls

BARRIERS — SPOTLIGHT

The Barrier Most of Us Feel

It's not that you don't know English.
It's that you're afraid of getting it wrong.

Every fluent speaker you admire made thousands of mistakes before they got good.

Fluency is a skill built by speaking — not a talent you're born with. The only real difference between you and a confident English speaker is repetition.

Breaking the Barriers

1. Practise speaking daily, even alone in front of a mirror
2. Listen actively — don't just wait for your turn to talk
3. Ask "Could you repeat that?" instead of nodding when confused
4. Keep language simple — clarity beats big vocabulary
5. Record yourself speaking and listen back

SECTION 3

Languages of the World & Why English

Understanding the language that connects the globe

LANGUAGES OF THE WORLD

A World of 7,000+ Languages

7,170

living languages spoken worldwide today

400+

languages spoken within India alone

Source: Ethnologue, 29th edition (2026)

Why English? Why Now?

1

Historical Spread

British trade & colonial reach carried English into 60+ countries

2

Business & Science

Most international business and research is conducted in English

3

Internet & Tech

A majority of online technical content is written in English

4

Aviation & Diplomacy

The standard language of international aviation & global bodies

English has about 1.5 billion speakers worldwide (native + second-language) — more total speakers than any other language on Earth.

Why It Matters for YOU

- Most campus interviews are conducted in English
- Technical documentation, code comments, and reports are written in English
- Global and remote teams communicate primarily in English
- Communication skill is directly linked to employability, as we saw earlier

Improving your English isn't about replacing your mother tongue — it's about adding a professional tool to a toolbox you already have.

60-SECOND ENERGIZER

Stand up. Stretch.
Turn to 2 people around you and say one English sentence about how the session is going so far.

SECTION 4

The 7 Cs of Effective Communication

The global standard for clear, professional communication

The 7 Cs at a Glance

1. **Clear**
2. **Concise**
3. **Concrete**
4. **Correct**
5. **Coherent**
6. **Complete**
7. **Courteous**

Clear & Concise

1 Clear

One idea at a time, in simple words, with no room for confusion.

Weak: *"The thing is kind of not really working the way we planned it to, sort of."*
Strong: "The plan didn't work because of X."

2 Concise

Say it in as few words as possible, without losing meaning.

Weak: *"I am writing this email in order to inform you that..."*
Strong: "I'm writing to inform you that..."

Concrete & Correct

3 Concrete

Use specific facts, examples, and numbers — not vague claims.

Weak: *"I am good at teamwork."*
Strong: "I led a 4-member team to finish our final-year project 2 weeks early."

4 Correct

Accurate grammar, facts, and information — always double-checked.

Weak: *Guessing the interviewer's name or company facts*
Strong: Verifying tense, spelling, and facts before you speak or send

Coherent, Complete & Courteous

5

Coherent

Ideas flow logically, one leading naturally to the next.

6

Complete

Give the receiver all the information they need — don't leave them guessing.

7

Courteous

A polite, respectful, and considerate tone — even when disagreeing or declining.

Spot the Missing C

In pairs, decide which C is missing in each message below — and how you'd fix it.

"Sir I want this job because I want it very very badly and also because it is a very good company and also I need it."

Missing: Concise / Concrete

Email opening: "hey wassup, i need the offer letter"

Missing: Courteous / Correct (tone)

"I have skills."

Missing: Concrete / Complete

CLOSING

Closing the Loop

Let's bring it all together

RECAP

Today, in One Page

- ✓ Communication = shared understanding, not just talking
- ✓ SMCR: Sender → Message → Channel → Receiver (+ Feedback & Noise)
- ✓ 3 types: Verbal, Non-verbal, Written — all three are assessed in placements
- ✓ Barriers: Language, Psychological, Physical, Cultural, Technological
- ✓ English: ~1.5 billion speakers — the language of global business
- ✓ 7 Cs: Clear, Concise, Concrete, Correct, Coherent, Complete, Courteous

RECAP

Your 3-Habit Action Plan

1

SPEAK

10 minutes of English daily — to a friend, a mirror, or yourself

2

READ / WATCH

English news headlines, or a show with English subtitles, daily

3

PRACTICE

Record a 1-minute self-introduction weekly and listen back

Small daily practice beats one big cram session before placements.

OPEN FLOOR

Your Turn: Questions, Suggestions, Doubts

Ask in English or Hindi — whichever helps you say it clearly.

If you don't want to ask aloud, write your question on a chit and pass it forward — I'll read a few out anonymously.

Thank You!

Every expert communicator was once exactly where you are today — the only difference is they kept speaking. Your turn starts now.

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